

4.4 Safe Computing

There are many precautions you can take while computing. Here are a few you should follow if you're paranoid about your security:

Firewalls And Security

- Use a firewall if you have an always on Internet connection. Corporations can invest in hardware-based firewall security for their networks, while home users can opt for software-based personal firewalls.
- Turn off file sharing on your PC when you don't need it. If a port scan is done on your computer, a hacker may find a back door to your machine and have access to your files via file sharing.
- Don't open attachments when you receive e-mail from unknown sources and the subject line seems unfamiliar.
- Don't let other people use your computer, unless you really trust them. If you really have to share, then create a guest login for the other users with limited rights.
- Routinely update Windows software. The updates will fix many bugs and known security holes within the Windows operating system.
- In case, regularly used programs have options for auto-update, keep them on. You never know when a lethal security bug may be discovered.

Privacy Protection

- Your account is only as secure as its password. Create passwords with nonsensical combinations of upper and lower case letters, numbers and symbols. Also, change your passwords often. If you must write down or record your password, take steps to disguise the information so no one else can make out what it is.
- Look at the privacy policy of the online services you use and also before you enter private information in online forms. However, if you are not satisfied with the policy, or if there is no policy posted, avoid giving any personal information to that site.